

ROASTED ZAATAR AUBERGINES

Loaded with flavour!

SALAD

INGREDIENTS

1 globe eggplant
1 ½ tablespoons olive oil
1 tablespoon zaatar spice mix
1 tablespoon Ras el Hanout
¼ teaspoon salt, more to taste
1 fat garlic clove

METHOD

Step 1: Preheat oven to 200C

Step 2: Slice Eggplant in half, then slice deeply at a diagonal at one inch intervals - "crosshatching" (see photos above) careful not to cut through skin.

Step 3: Season each side with ¼ teaspoon kosher salt, sprinkling it into the slices if possible.

Step 4: Mix oil, spices, garlic together in a bowl to make a paste. Brush or spoon the entire contents over the eggplant and place on a sheet pan in the oven and bake for 1 hour rotating halfway through. After an hour, pierce with a fork and if they are very tender and juicy, they are done. Bigger eggplants may take longer.

TAHINI SAUCE

INGREDIENTS

½ cup tahini paste (liquids and solids both – not just the "oil".)
¼ cup warm tap water, more to desired consistency.
1–2 tablespoons lemon juice (or add to taste)
2 garlic cloves (finely minced)
½ teaspoon kosher salt (see notes)
¼ teaspoon pepper

METHOD

Step 1: If your tahini paste has separated try to mix it in the jar with a fork before measuring. If it's very cold, this may not work very well, so be sure to use both the solids and the oil.

Step 2: Make the tahini sauce in a medium bowl, start by adding the tahini.

Step 3: If your tahini sauce is very cold, whisk using a fork or mini whisk, with the warm water. Start with ¼ cup warm water, and add more to desired consistency. (½ cup) for a looser "dressing" consistency. Or feel free to keep it thick. Also keep in mind, different brands of tahini paste are thicker than others. Once you start whisking, it will actually thicken.

Step 4: Add the remaining ingredients to the jar – lemon juice, minced garlic, salt, pepper and whisk until creamy and smooth. It will thicken as it cools in fridge.

Taste and adjust salt and lemon to your liking.

THE COOKERY

by The Secret Jozi Chef

FATTOUSH

INGREDIENTS

2 loaves pita bread
Early Harvest Extra Virgin Olive Oil
1/2 tsp sumac, more for later
Salt and pepper
1 heart of Romaine lettuce, chopped
1 English cucumber, chopped
5 Roma tomatoes, chopped
5 green onions (both white and green parts),
chopped
5 radishes, stems removed, thinly sliced
2 cups chopped fresh parsley leaves, stems
removed
1 cup chopped fresh mint leaves (optional)

LIME-VINAIGRETTE

1 1/2 lime, juice of
1/3 cup Extra Virgin Olive Oil
Salt and pepper
1 tsp ground sumac
1/4 tsp ground cinnamon
scant 1/4 tsp ground allspice

METHOD

Step 1

Toast the pita bread in your toaster oven until it is crisp but not browned. Heat 3 tbsp of olive oil in a large pan. Break the pita bread into pieces, and place in the heated oil. Fry briefly until browned, tossing frequently. Add salt, pepper and 1/2 tsp of sumac. Remove the pita chips from the heat and place on paper towels to drain.

Step 2: In a large mixing bowl, combine the chopped lettuce, cucumber, tomatoes, green onions with the sliced radish and parsley.

Step 3: To make the lime vinaigrette, whisk together the lime juice, olive oil and spices in a small bowl.

Step 4: Dress the salad with the vinaigrette and toss lightly. Finally, add the pita chips, and more sumac if you like, and toss one more time. Transfer to small serving bowls or plates. Enjoy!

THE COOKERY

by The Secret Jozi Chef

BABA GANOUSH

Smokey aubergine and tahini dip

INGREDIENTS

1 large eggplant
1/4 cup tahini, plus more as needed
3 garlic cloves, minced
1/4 cup fresh lemon juice, plus more as needed
1 pinch ground cumin
salt, to taste
1 tablespoon extra virgin olive oil
1 tablespoon chopped fresh flat-leaf parsley
1/4 cup brine-cured black olives, such as kalamata, stones removed

METHOD

STEP 1:

Prick the eggplant with a fork in several places and bake in a hot oven for 25-40 minutes until the aubergine is blistered and soft

STEP 2:

Remove from the oven, let cool slightly, and peel off and discard the skin.

STEP 3:

Place the eggplant flesh in a bowl. Using a fork, mash the eggplant to a paste. Add the 1/4 cup tahini, the garlic, the 1/4 cup lemon juice and the cumin and mix well.

STEP 4:

Season with salt, then taste and add more tahini and/or lemon juice, if desired.

STEP 5:

Transfer the mixture to a serving bowl and spread with the back of a spoon to form a shallow well.

Drizzle the olive oil over the top and sprinkle with the paprika.

THE
COOKERY

by The Secret Jozi Chef

HUMMUS

INGREDIENTS

1 can chick peas
2tbsp Tahini
4 cloves garlic,crushed
2 tsp ground cumin
1/4 cup lemon juice
3 tbsp olive oil
Large pinch cayenne pepper
Vegetable stock
Extra lemon juice, olive oil, paprika and flat
leaf to garnish

METHOD

STEP 1:

Place all the ingredients, except the vegetable stock, into a food processor and process until smooth

STEP 2:

With the motor running, slowly add vegetable stock until the desired consistency is achieved

STEP 3:

Check and adjust seasoning

STEP 4:

Serve in a bowl, topped with a sprinkle of paprika, drizzle of olive oil and a splash of lemon juice

THE COOKERY

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MOROCCAN SPICED ORANGES

INGREDIENTS

2 1/2 cups orange sections, cut into 1/2-inch pieces (about 6)
1/4 cup slivered almonds
2 1/2 tablespoons chopped pitted dates (about 4)
1 tablespoon powdered sugar
1 tablespoon fresh lemon juice
1/4 teaspoon ground cinnamon

Ground cinnamon (optional)
Grated orange rind (optional)

METHOD

Step 1

Peel oranges carefully removing all white membrane, then carefully cut wedges of orange, removing the segments from the central pith
Set aside in a bowl

Step 2

Now add the remaining ingredients, and gently stir to combine

Step 3

Set aside in the fridge to chill and then serve plain

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CHICKPEA SALAD WITH SUMAC ONIONS

INGREDIENTS

1 x 14oz can of precooked chickpea / garbanzo beans
1tsp/5ml ground sumac
1tsp/5ml ground cumin
½ medium red onion, halved and thinly sliced
10 cherry tomatoes, quartered
3 spring onions/scallions, finely chopped
1 red bell pepper, deseeded and finely chopped
40g spinach leaves, washed and roughly chopped

For the dressing:

30ml/2tbsp extra virgin olive oil
½ juice of lemon
Salt and freshly ground black pepper to taste
Sprinkle of extra sumac to serve
Flatbread or pita bread to serve

METHOD

Step 1

In a mixing bowl, rub a pinch of salt and ground sumac into the onion slices with your hands really well. This will soften the onions and make them more palatable, will also help infuse tangy sumac to the onion slices.

Step 2

Place the precooked chickpeas or garbanzo beans on a colander, drain its liquid and rinse over running water. Combine the chickpeas with the onions in the mixing bowl. Stir in the ground cumin and season with salt to your taste, mix well.

Step 3

Stir in the chopped tomatoes, peppers, spring onion and spinach into the bowl and combine well with the chickpeas and onion mixture.

Step 4

For the dressing; combine the extra virgin olive oil and lemon juice in a small container. Season with salt and freshly ground pepper to your taste.

Step 5

Pour in the seasoning over the salad and combine well. Transfer the salad into a serving plate. Serve with an extra pinch of ground sumac sprinkled over, if you like, with plenty flat breads or pita bread by the side, to mop up the delicious juices.

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Kisir - Turkish Bulgur Salad

INGREDIENTS

2 cups fine or extra fine bulgur
2 cups boiling water, plus more if needed
3 tablespoons extra virgin olive oil, plus more for drizzling
1/4 cup tomato paste
3 tablespoons Turkish red pepper paste
1 teaspoon Urfa pepper or red pepper flakes
1/2 teaspoon ground cumin
Kosher salt
2 tablespoons pomegranate molasses
1/2 lemon, juiced
6 green onions
3 ripe but firm Roma tomatoes
1 cup chopped fresh parsley, plus more for garnish

METHOD

1. **Prepare the bulgur:** Place **1/2 cup of bulgur** in a mixing bowl. Pour in **1 cup of boiling water**, stirring gently to help absorption. Add just enough additional boiling water to cover the grains, then cover the bowl and let it sit until the bulgur is tender and has absorbed all liquid—about 15 minutes.
2. **Make the flavorful paste:** Heat a small pan over medium heat and warm **olive oil** with **tomato paste, Turkish pepper paste, Urfa Biber**, cumin, and a **generous pinch of salt**. Stir until the pastes are fully melted and blended into a fragrant mixture.
3. **Combine the flavors:** Pour the warmed paste mixture over the bulgur, then drizzle in **pomegranate molasses, fresh lemon juice**, and a little more olive oil. Mix thoroughly—traditionally, this step is done by kneading with gloved hands to fully coat the bulgur in the paste.
4. **Cool and prep:** Transfer the bulgur mixture to the refrigerator to cool while you prepare the remaining ingredients.
5. **Chop the vegetables and herbs:** Trim and finely chop **green onions** (both white and green parts). Dice **ripe tomatoes**, ensuring they aren't overly watery—if needed, halve them and squeeze out the seeds before chopping.
6. **Assemble the salad:** Once the bulgur is fully cooled, fold in the chopped **green onions, tomatoes**, and **fresh parsley****. Taste and adjust seasoning as needed.
7. **Finish and serve:** Garnish generously with **more fresh parsley** and serve immediately.

THE
COOKERY

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QUICK FALAFEL

INGREDIENTS

1 can chickpeas (rinsed, drained and patted dry)
1/3 cup chopped fresh parsley
4 cloves garlic, minced
2 medium shallots (minced)
2 Tbsp raw sesame seeds
1 1/2 tsp cumin (plus more to taste)
1/4 tsp each sea salt and black pepper (plus more to taste)
1 healthy pinch coriander (optional)
3-4 Tbsp all-purpose flour
3-4 Tbsp oil for cooking
Bread crumbs for coating

METHOD

Step 1:

Add chickpeas, parsley, shallot, garlic, sesame seeds, cumin, salt, pepper (and coriander and cardamom if using) to a food processor or blender and mix/pulse to combine, scraping down sides as needed until thoroughly combined. You're looking for a crumbly dough, not a paste.

Step 2:

Add flour 1 Tbsp at a time and PULSE to combine until no longer wet and you can mold the dough into a ball without it sticking to your hands - about 4 Tbsp

Step 3:

Taste and adjust seasonings as needed. I added a bit more salt, pepper, and a dash of coriander. You want the flavor to be pretty bold, so don't be shy.

Step 4

Transfer to a mixing bowl, cover and refrigerate for 1-2 hours to firm up. If you're in a hurry you can chill in the freezer for 45 minutes or skip this step - but they will be a little more fragile when cooking.

Step 5

Once chilled, scoop out rounded Tablespoon amounts (~30 g in weight // I used this scoop) and gently form into 11-12 small discs (amount as original recipe is written // adjust if altering batch size).

OPTIONAL: Sprinkle on panko bread crumbs and gently press to adhere - flip and repeat. This will produce a crispier falafel, but it's optional.

Step 6

Heat a large skillet over medium heat and add enough oil to generously coat the pan - about 2 Tbsp (30 ml). Swirl to coat.

Step 7

Once the oil is hot, add only as many falafel as will fit very comfortably in the pan at a time - about 5-7.

Step 8

Cook for a total of 4-5 minutes, flipping when the underside is deep golden brown. Repeat until all falafel are browned - the deeper golden brown they are, the crispier they'll be. They will also firm up more once slightly cooled.

THE COOKERY

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MANAKISH

Ingredients

2 tsp active dry yeast
300 ml water (warm)
500 g flour
2 tsp salt
2 tsp sugar
12 tbsp olive oil
6 tbsp Za'atar
300 g halloumi
lemon (for serving)

Method

Step 1:

Dissolve yeast in lukewarm water. Add flour, salt, and sugar to a bowl. Make a well and add yeast mixture, followed by one third of the olive oil. Work into a dough using your hands and knead for 5 min. until elastic. The dough should spring back when poked with your finger. Form dough into a ball, place in a large bowl, oil the top, and cover with plastic wrap. Set aside somewhere warm for 1 hr.

Step 2: Once the dough has risen, roll out into a log and divide into 4 equal pieces. Place on a parchment-lined baking sheet and press out slightly into flatbreads. Cover with a clean kitchen towel and let rise again while you prepare the topping. Mix the Za'atar with remaining olive oil. Grate halloumi on the largest side of a box grater, then add to the Za'atar mixture and mix to combine.

Step 3: Preheat oven to 200°C/400°F. Stretch out the flatbreads and dimple the surfaces with your fingertips. Top each generously with the Za'atar-halloumi mixture and drizzle more olive oil, if desired. Transfer to oven and bake for approx. 8 min. Serve immediately with lemon wedges. Enjoy!

THE COOKERY

by The Secret Jozi Chef

The Colony Shopping Centre, 345 Jan Smuts Avenue, Craighall, 2024.

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SHORBAT ADAS

CREAMY LENTIL SOUP

INGREDIENTS

1.5 cups Red Lentils
6 cups chicken/vegetable stock
1 cup Carrots chopped
1 Onion chopped
2 Garlic cloves chopped
1 tbsp Olive oil
Salt & Pepper to taste
1 tsp Cumin
1/2 tsp Turmeric

METHOD

- 1.** In a pot, add the olive oil. To that, add the onions, garlic, and carrots. Add salt and pepper to this and then saute for 5 minutes until fragrant.
- 2.** To that, add the lentils and saute for a few minutes. Season with the cumin and turmeric. Mix together.
- 3.** Add the cooking liquid and bring this mixture to a boil. Once it reaches a boil, bring down to a simmer. Let this cook for about 25 minutes until the carrots are tender.
- 4.** Once tender, use an immersion blender to puree this soup until creamy. If you do not have an immersion blender, then pour the contents of the soup into a regular blender for a minute until smooth.
- 5.** Enjoy with crispy pita chips and fresh lemon juice!

THE
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KHORESH FESENJOON

CHICKEN IN POMEGRANATE SAUCE

INGREDIENTS

4 chicken thighs, with skin and bone on

4 tablespoons natural oil, divided

1 onion, diced

2 cups walnuts

1/2 cup water

1/2 to 1 cup pomegranate molasses, amount varies based on different brands

1/2 teaspoon salt

1/4 teaspoon pepper, ground

1/8 teaspoon ground saffron, dissolved in 1 tablespoon hot water

1 tablespoon fresh lemon juice, optional and as needed

1-4 tablespoons sugar, optional and as needed

Instructions

METHOD

1. Place the chicken pieces in a Dutch oven with 2 tablespoons of oil on medium-high heat. Sear the chicken on both sides until it becomes golden and crispy, 5 minutes on each side.

2. Remove from the pot and set it aside. You can leave the chicken fat in the pot or remove it. However, if you decide to discard the fat, you will need to add 2 more tablespoons of oil to sauté the onions in the next step.

3. Toss in the onions and sauté for 10 minutes until lightly brown. While the onions are cooking, in a food processor pulse the walnuts until finely ground. Don't overdo it, otherwise, you will have walnut butter. Set aside.

4. Add the ground walnuts to the pan with onions and stir over medium heat for a couple of minutes.

5. Add the water, pomegranate molasses, salt, and pepper and stir to incorporate all the items into the pan.

6. Now return the chicken and any accumulated juice to the pan and press them down to fully immerse them into the sauce.

7. Cover, keep the flame on low, and simmer for 45 minutes. Take extra care and stir occasionally to prevent this thick stew from burning on the bottom.

8. Taste and make any necessary adjustments by adding more pomegranate molasses if needed. You're aiming for a robust pomegranate flavor with a balanced sweet and tart profile.

9. Continue to simmer for another 45-60 minutes. The stew should have turned into a deep maroon color and the chicken should be fork tender.

10. Add the saffron water, stir, and taste one more time and make any last minute adjustments by adding more sugar or lemon juice, if desired.

11. Remove from the heat and allow to sit for 10 minutes before serving.

12. Serve with steamed Persian saffron basmati rice.

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PERSIAN SAFFRON RICE

LIGHT, FLUFFY AND FRAGRANT

INGREDIENTS

10 saffron strands, ground or 1/8 teaspoon ground saffron

1 cup basmati rice

2 tablespoons extra virgin olive oil

1 small yellow or white onion, finely diced

1 garlic clove, crushed or minced

1 1/2 cups vegetable stock, chicken stock, or water

1 bay leaf

1 small lime, zested

Kosher salt

METHOD

1. Grind and bloom the saffron: Add the saffron threads to a spice grinder or mortar and pestle. Grind the strands into a fine powder. Mix 1/8 teaspoon of the ground saffron with 3 tablespoons of water. This process is called blooming and will draw the color and complex flavor from the spice far more effectively than using the strands. Set aside to bloom.

2. Rinse the rice: Put the rice in a fine mesh strainer and rinse with cold water until the water runs clear.

3. Sauté the aromatics: In a medium saucepan set over medium-high heat, add the olive oil. When the oil shimmers, add the diced onion. Cook, stirring, until the onion softens and turns translucent. Add the crushed garlic and stir until the aroma is released, about 30 seconds.

4. Toast the rice and add the bloomed saffron: Add the rice to the pot with the onions and the garlic and toss until it is well coated in the onion mixture. Add the bloomed saffron liquid and stir until everything is well mixed.

5. Add the broth and bring to a boil: Add the broth or water, bay leaf, and lime zest. If you're using water or low sodium broth, season with a good pinch of kosher salt. Give the mixture a stir, then bring the water to a boil. Once boiling, turn the heat to low and cover the pot. Cook until the rice has absorbed the water, about 15 to 20 minutes.

THE
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by The Secret Jozi Chef

EZME - THE DIP ALL SAUCE

INGREDIENTS

3 large tomatoes, firm and fresh
1 medium white onion
1 green bell pepper
1 red bell pepper
2 cloves garlic, minced
1/2 cup fresh parsley, finely chopped
1 tbsp tomato paste
1 lemon, juice of
2 tbsp olive oil , extra virgin
1 tsp kosher salt
1/2 tsp black pepper
1/2 tsp Aleppo pepper
1 tsp sumac

METHOD

1. **Finely dice** the **tomatoes** and place them in a bowl. Mince the **onions** and **peppers** just as finely, then fold them into the tomatoes.
2. Stir in **minced garlic** and **chopped parsley**, ensuring the flavors blend evenly.
3. Add **tomato paste, olive oil, lemon juice, salt, black pepper, Aleppo pepper, and sumac**, mixing thoroughly until every bite is infused with richness.
4. Cover and refrigerate for **30 minutes** to allow the flavors to meld.
5. Serve chilled as a **mezze, sauce, or vibrant salad** alongside your favorite dishes.

THE
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KOFTA - FRAGRANT LAMB MEATBALLS

INGREDIENTS

1/4 cup each pine nuts, almonds, and walnuts (total 3/4 cup)
1/2 cup breadcrumbs
1 small yellow onion, roughly chopped
3 cloves garlic, roughly chopped
1 small red bell pepper, roughly chopped
1 small jalapeño pepper, seeds and ribs removed, roughly chopped
1/2 cup cilantro leaves, gently packed (okay to substitute parsley)
900gms ground lamb
3/4 teaspoon ground cumin
Heaping 1/4 teaspoon ground cinnamon
Heaping 1/4 teaspoon ground cardamom
Heaping 1/4 teaspoon ground cloves
1-1/2 teaspoons salt
1/4 teaspoon white pepper
Tzatziki and hummus, for serving

METHOD

- 1. Toast the nuts:** Pulse **nuts** in a **food processor** until finely chopped, then transfer to a dry skillet. Toast over **medium heat**, stirring, until fragrant (**5–6 minutes**). Cool in a mixing bowl.
- 2. Prepare the vegetables:** Pulse **onion, garlic, bell pepper, jalapeño, and cilantro** until finely minced. Wring out excess liquid using a clean dishcloth, then add to the bowl with nuts.
- 3. Mix the kofta:** Combine **lamb, cumin, cinnamon, cardamom, cloves, salt, and white pepper** with the nut mixture. Mash with hands until evenly blended.
- 4. Shape & chill:** Form into patties, place on a **baking sheet**, cover, and refrigerate until ready to cook.
- 5. Grill:** Preheat to **medium-high**, oil the grates, and cook **4 minutes per side**, covered, until browned and cooked through.
- 6. Serve:** Enjoy with **tzatziki and hummus**.

THE
COOKERY

by The Secret Jozi Chef

Muska Böreği -

PHYLLO & SPINACH PIES

INGREDIENTS

SALAD INGREDIENTS

1kg. fresh spinach, washed, dried, trimmed, and coarsely chopped
3 Tbs. extra-virgin olive oil
1 bunch scallions (about 3 oz. or 10 small), white and light-green parts only, trimmed and finely chopped
2 cups crumbled feta cheese (10 oz.)
1/2 cup finely grated parmesan
1 cup grated mozzarella
2 large eggs, lightly beaten 1tsp paprika
1/2tsp ground cumin
1/3 cup finely chopped fresh flat-leaf parsley 1/4 tsp. freshly grated nutmeg
Kosher or fine sea salt

1/3 cup extra-virgin olive oil for brushing; more as needed
500g frozen phyllo dough, thawed and at room temperature
2 tsp. milk

TIP:

METHOD

1. **Wilt the spinach:** Heat a **10-inch sauté pan** over medium-high. Add **a few handfuls of spinach**, tossing with tongs. As it wilts, add more gradually, cooking until bright green (**about 4 minutes**). Transfer to a colander, let cool slightly, and squeeze out excess liquid.

2. **Prepare the filling:** Wipe the pan clean, then heat **oil** over medium. Sauté **scallions and garlic** until soft (**about 4 minutes**), then stir in **paprika and cumin**. Add **spinach**, remove from heat, and let cool **5 minutes**. Mix in **cheeses, eggs, parsley, nutmeg, and salt** until well combined.

3. **Layer the phyllo:** Lightly oil a **9×13-inch baking pan**. Brush **phyllo sheets** with oil and layer as instructed, ensuring overlapping edges cover the pan.

4. **Assemble & seal:** Add **3 centered sheets**, then spread the **filling evenly**. Layer the remaining sheets using the same pattern, then press edges down to seal.

5. **Score & bake:** Using a sharp knife, **score the top into 24 rectangles**, brushing **milk** along the cuts to prevent flaking. **Bake at 175°C** for 35–45 minutes, until golden brown.

6. **Serve:** Let cool slightly before cutting along score marks. Enjoy warm!

THE
COOKERY

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PIYAZ - SHEPHERDS SALAD

INGREDIENTS

1 can cannellini beans drained
2 tomatoes diced
1/2 red onion thinly sliced
1 cup fresh parsley chopped
1 tsp sumac
1/2 tsp Aleppo pepper 1/2 tsp salt
1 lemon juice of
2 tbsp olive oil

METHOD

1. Place the **drained cannellini beans** in a large bowl and **add chopped tomatoes, sliced red onions and chopped parsley** to the beans. Stir well and set aside.
2. In a small bowl, **mix sumac, Aleppo pepper, salt, lemon juice and olive oil** and pour it on the salad.
3. **Toss the salad** with the **dressing** and refrigerate for 30 minutes. Serve cold as a side dish.

THE
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SHISH TAOUK

INGREDIENTS

1 cup whole-milk Greek yogurt
2 tablespoons freshly squeezed lemon juice, or more to taste
2 tablespoons olive oil
2 tbsp tomato paste
6 cloves garlic, minced
1 tablespoon red pepper flakes
1/2 tablespoon salt
1 1/2 teaspoons ground cumin
1 teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
1 teaspoon paprika
1/8 teaspoon ground cinnamon
1200 gms pounds boneless, skinless chicken thighs, halved
4 long metal skewers

METHOD

1. Whisk yogurt, lemon juice, olive oil, tomato paste, garlic, red pepper flakes, salt, cumin, black pepper, paprika, and cinnamon together in a bowl.
2. Place chicken thigh halves into the yogurt marinade and coat them thoroughly on all sides. Cover bowl with plastic wrap and refrigerate 2 to 8 hours.
3. Preheat an outdoor grill for medium-high heat and lightly oil the grate.
Using 2 skewers for each kebab, thread half of the chicken thighs onto each pair of skewers making a fairly thick "log" shape.
4. Place kebabs on grill. Do not try to turn them until they begin to unstick from the grill, 3 or 4 minutes. Turn kebabs and grill the other side 3 or 4 minutes; turn. Continue cooking and turning until chicken is no longer pink in the center and the juices run clear, about 6 minutes.

THE
COOKERY

by The Secret Jozi Chef

ROSE BAKLAVA

INGREDIENTS

500gms mixed nuts (walnut & almond)

1 teaspoon ground cinnamon
1 package phyllo dough
1 cup butter, melted

1 cup white sugar
1 cup water
3tbsp rose water
1/2 cup honey
1 teaspoon vanilla extract
1 teaspoon grated lemon zest

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 175 degrees C. Butter a 9x13 inch baking dish.
2. Place the nuts and the cinnamon into a food processor and pulse until a fine texture, but do not overwork
3. Unroll phyllo and cut whole stack in half to fit the dish. Cover phyllo with a damp cloth while assembling the baklava, to keep it from drying out.
4. Place two sheets of phyllo in the bottom of the prepared dish. Brush generously with butter. Sprinkle 2 to 3 tablespoons of the nut mixture on top. Repeat layers until all ingredients are used, ending with about 6 sheets of phyllo. Using a sharp knife, cut baklava (all the way through to the bottom of the dish) into four long rows, then (nine times) diagonally to make 36 diamond shapes.
5. Bake in preheated oven 50 minutes, until golden and crisp.
6. While baklava is baking, combine sugar and water in a small saucepan over medium heat and bring to a boil. Stir in honey, vanilla and lemon zest, reduce heat and simmer 20 minutes, once reduced add the rose water.
7. Remove the baklava from the oven and immediately spoon the syrup over it. Let cool completely before serving.
8. Store uncovered.

THE
COOKERY

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TABOULEH

INGREDIENTS

SALAD

1,5 cups couscous
2tbsp olive oil
1 tsp salt

15 cherry tomatoes, seeded and chopped
30gms fresh parsley
30gms coriander
20gms mint
1 small cucumber, seeds removed, and chopped
1/2 red pepper, cut into tiny pieces
1/2 red onion, cut into tiny pieces
2tbsp finely chopped chives
1/2 cup flaked almonds

Juice of 1 lemon
4 tbsp olive oil
2 tbsp red wine vinegar
1 clove garlic, crushed

INGREDIENTS

DRESSING

Juice of 1 lemon
4 tbsp olive oil
2 tbsp red wine vinegar
1 clove garlic, crushed

METHOD

STEP 1

Place the couscous in a bowl, add salt and stir. Boil water, and add just enough to cover the couscous. Wrap with cling wrap and set aside.

STEP 2

Prepare all the individual ingredients, cutting everything into a very small dice.

STEP 3

To assemble the salad, start by loosening the couscous with a fork. The couscous should be loose and fluffy.

STEP 4

Now add all the prepared ingredients to the couscous, add everything before stirring to mix to avoid making the couscous mushy

STEP 5

Add the dressing and gently stir to combine all the ingredients.

METHOD

STEP 1

Prepare your dressing by combining the juice of 1 lemon, 4 tbsp olive oil, 2 tbsp wine vinegar, salt, pepper and the crushed garlic.

STEP 2

Set aside until needed

THE COOKERY

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PIDE

INGREDIENTS

For the dough:

300 gr + 2 tbsp. all-purpose plain flour
1 tsp. salt
14 gr dried yeast
1 pinch of sugar
1 cup warm water 3 tbsp. olive oil

For the topping:

1 medium onion, finely chopped
2 cloves garlic
400 gr/14 oz. ground beef or ground lamb or mixture
½ red/yellow bell pepper or 1 green pointy pepper, finely diced
2 medium tomatoes, deseeded and diced
1 tbsp. lemon juice
1 tbsp. olive oil
1/2 tsp ground cumin 1/2 tsp cinnamon
1 tsp paprika
1 tsp ground all spice 1/2 tsp chili powder
1 tbsp tomato paste
Small bunch flat leaf parsley
Salt (1 tsp. salt is recommended) and freshly ground black pepper to taste

Pinch chili powder

1 egg + 15 ml/ 1 tbsp. olive oil to brush the pide

METHOD

Step 1: Preheat the oven to 180 C/ 350 F

Step 2: Stir in the dried yeast and sugar in a small bowl and pour in ½ cup warm water. Dissolve the yeast in water, mixing with your fingers. Set aside for the yeast mixture to get frothy for 5 minutes.

Step 3: Combine the flour and salt in a large bowl. Make a well in the middle and pour in 2 tbsp. olive oil and the yeast mixture.

Step 4: Pour in the remaining ½ warm water to the flour mixture. Using your hands, draw in the flour from the sides and work the mixture into a dough.

Step 5: Knead for 3 -5 minutes, until you reach a soft, smooth dough. The dough gets sticky as you knead, so pour the remaining 1 tbsp. olive oil and stir in additional 2 tbsp. flour to help shape into a soft dough.

Step 6: Place the dough in large bowl and cover with a cling film. Leave it in a warm place for 1 hour; it will be doubled in size.

Step 7: In the meantime, prepare your filling. Heat 15ml/ 1tbsp. olive oil in a wide heavy pan and stir in the onions, garlic and peppers. Sauté for 2-3 minutes over medium heat, until they start to soften.

Step 8: Stir in the tomatoes and sauté for another 2 minutes. Pour in the lemon juice and season with salt and ground black pepper. Turn the heat off.

Place the ground meat, spices, tomato paste and fresh herbs in a bowl and combine with the cooked vegetables mix well. The topping is ready.

Step 9: Once the dough is risen, place the dough on a lightly floured surface. Knead the dough for a minute then divide the dough into two pieces and roll into two balls.

Step 10: On a lightly floured surface, roll the dough balls into 2 oval shapes of 20 cm x 40 cm, with ½ cm (0.2") thickness. Line a large baking tray with baking paper and place the 2 oval flat bread dough on the tray.

Step 11: Spread the filling evenly over the 2 flat breads, leaving 2 cm at the edges as a border with no filling (it is easier to spread the filling while the oval flat bread is in the tray). Fold in the sides to act as border to keep the filling intact. Squeeze the oval dough at each end to make it pointy.

Step 12: Beat an egg in a small bowl and mix it with 1 tbsp. olive oil. Brush the edges of dough with this mixture.

Bake for 25 - 30 minutes, until the pides are golden brown and crispy at the edges.

Step 13: Once cool, cut into slices and serve.

THE COOKERY

by The Secret Jozi Chef